Change Request: KD ConnX Upgrade to v7.1

ConnX HR/Workforce Management System — Version 7.1.0 2955

Change ID	4429442	**Priority**	Medium
Requested By	[Requestor Name]	**Change Type**	**Emergency Change**
Environment	Production	**Risk Level**	Medium
Submission Date	2026-02-26	**Target Completion**	TBD
Vendor	ConnX Pty Ltd	**Target Version**	v7.1.0 2955 (20260203)

KDR Environment Details

Component	Server / Location	Notes
ConnX Web Application (IIS)	`KDR-AZAPP01`	ConnX site hosted in IIS; all upgrader steps run here
ConnX Database (SQL Server)	`KDR-AZSQL01`	Log in as local Administrator account
SQL Admin Credentials	ITGlue - KDR-AZSQL01 Local Admin	Local Administrator account for SQL server access
ConnX Install Path	`C:\inetpub` (on KDR-AZAPP01)	ConnX application files location
Application Backup Path	`C:\TempPath` (on KDR-AZAPP01)	Temporary backup of C:\inetpub before upgrade
Database Backup Path	`G:\SQLBackups\ConnX` (on KDR-AZSQL01)	SQL database backup location
Upgrade Package Source	Download link from KDR email	If link unavailable, contact Jacob.Dack@connx.com.au

1. Change Summary

Upgrade the KD ConnX HR/Workforce Management system from the current version to ConnX v7.1.0 2955. This upgrade includes application files, database schema updates, IIS configuration changes, ConnX Web Service (CWS) upgrade, and ConnX Automation Process (CAP) reinstallation.

> **Business Justification:** Upgrade to the latest supported version of ConnX to maintain vendor support, access new features, security patches, and ensure compatibility with current infrastructure. SQL Server 2014 is no longer supported by ConnX as of v7.1.

Key Upgrade Details

Category	Requirement	Details
Current Version	ConnX v6.5.0.2016 or greater	Minimum prerequisite for v7.1 upgrade
Target Version	**v7.1.0 2955**	Build date: 2026-02-03
SQL Server	**SQL Server 2016+**	SQL Server 2014 no longer supported; recommend SQL Server 2022
MicrOpay Version	v9.4 (if applicable)	Must match payroll database version
Upgrade Location	**ConnX Web Server ONLY**	Do NOT run on individual client machines

2. Scope of Change

2.1 Components Affected

Component	Action	Details
ConnX Web Application	UPGRADE	Application files replaced on IIS web server
ConnX Database	UPGRADE	Database schema updated by upgrader tool
ConnX Web Service (CWS)	UPGRADE	Web service component updated
ConnX Background Worker	UPGRADE	New background worker application pool configured
ConnX Automation Process (CAP)	UNINSTALL & REINSTALL	Previous version must be fully uninstalled before new CAP installed
ConnX eRecruitment Process Applicant Service	UNINSTALL & REINSTALL	Must also be removed and reinstalled from the upgrade package

IIS Application Pools	MODIFY	ConnX64 pool settings updated; CWS App pool defaults applied
MicrOpay Service	VERIFY / UPGRADE	Must match payroll database version (if applicable)
Custom Web Pages	RESTORE	Customisations must be re-applied post-upgrade via Customiser.exe

2.2 Prerequisites to Install

Prerequisite	Notes
URL Rewrite (x64)	IIS URL Rewrite module
Microsoft .NET Framework 4.8	Server reboot may be required after installation
Microsoft ASP.NET Core 6.0 Runtime	Required for ConnX Background Worker
SAP Crystal Reports Runtime 13.0 (x64)	Required for reporting module
Microsoft OLE DB Driver for SQL Server (x64)	Database connectivity

2.3 Users Affected

User Group	Impact	Duration
All ConnX users	System unavailable during upgrade window	Duration of maintenance window
Applications sharing ConnX app pool	App pool stopped during upgrade	Duration of maintenance window

3. Implementation Plan

Phase 1: Pre-Upgrade Preparation (No Downtime)			
Step	**Action**	**Duration**	**Rollback**
1.1	Confirm current ConnX version is v6.5.0.2016 or greater	5 min	N/A
1.2	Confirm SQL Server version is 2016 or above	5 min	N/A
1.3	Verify Access MicrOpay version (v9.4) if applicable	5 min	N/A

1.4	Verify external document datastore connectivity (*Admin* > *Setup* > *Settings* > *Uploads*)	5 min	N/A
1.5	Obtain upgrade download link from original KDR email. If link unavailable, contact **Jacob.Dack@connx.com.au** or ConnX Support on **1300 266 694**	5 min	N/A
1.6	Download the upgrade package onto `KDR-AZAPP01` and extract the .zip to a local folder	10 min	N/A
1.7	Verify RDP access to both `KDR-AZAPP01` (IIS) and `KDR-AZSQL01` (SQL). Retrieve local Admin credentials from ITGlue	5 min	N/A
1.8	Notify all **internal and external parties** of scheduled maintenance window	-	N/A
Phase 1 Total		**~40 min**	

Phase 1 Impact: NONE - Preparation tasks only. System remains fully operational.

Phase 2: ConnX Application Upgrade (MAINTENANCE WINDOW)			
Step	**Action**	**Duration**	**Rollback**
2.1	On `KDR-AZAPP01` : Stop the ConnX Automation Process (CAP) service via `Services.msc`	2 min	Start service
2.1a	On `KDR-AZAPP01` : Stop the ConnX site in IIS Manager and take a **manual backup** of `C:\inetpub` to `C:\TempPath`	10-15 min	Restore from C:\TempPath
2.1b	On `KDR-AZSQL01` : Log in as local Administrator (ITGlue credentials). Open SSMS and backup ConnX database to `G:\SQLBackups\ConnX` . **VERY IMPORTANT: Activate "Copy only backup" before clicking OK**	10-20 min	Restore from G:\SQLBackups\ConnX
2.2	On `KDR-AZAPP01` : Run `ConnXUpgrader.exe` as Administrator from the extracted upgrade package	2 min	Close upgrader
2.3	**Step 1:** Install prerequisites (URL Rewrite, .NET 4.8, ASP.NET Core 6.0, Crystal Reports, OLE DB)	15-30 min	Uninstall prerequisites
2.3a	**REBOOT** server if .NET 4.8 was installed	5-10 min	N/A
2.4	**Step 2:** Select ConnX instance to upgrade from IIS detected list	2 min	N/A

2.5	**Step 3:** Database validation — verify connection from `connectionstrings.config`	5 min	N/A
2.6	**Step 4:** Select ConnX Web Service (CWS) instance for upgrade	2 min	N/A
2.7	**Step 5:** Review IIS configuration changes (information only)	2 min	N/A
2.8	**Step 6:** Backup ConnX application files to a separate empty folder (NOT the ConnX directory or parent)	10-15 min	Restore from backup
2.9	**Step 7:** Backup ConnX database and Document Datastore database via SQL Server Management Studio	10-20 min	Restore from backup
2.10	**Perform Upgrade:** Upgrader applies application files and database schema updates	15-30 min	Restore application files + database from backup
2.11	Review upgrade log and manual tasks list	5 min	N/A
Phase 2 Total		**~60-120 min**	

> **Phase 2 Impact:** ConnX system UNAVAILABLE. All users will be unable to access ConnX during this phase. Any applications sharing the ConnX application pool will also be unavailable.

Phase 3: Services Update — CAP & eRecruitment (MAINTENANCE WINDOW)			
Step	**Action**	**Duration**	**Rollback**
3.1	On `KDR-AZAPP01` : Open *Services.msc* and remove **both**: • `ConnX Automation Process` • `ConnX eRecruitment Process Applicant Service`	5 min	Reinstall old versions from backup
3.2	Also uninstall both services via *Control Panel* > *Programs and Features*	5 min	N/A
3.3	Reinstall **ConnX Automation Process** — run `Setup.exe` as Administrator from the relevant directory in the extracted upgrade package; install for "Everyone"	5-10 min	Uninstall new CAP
3.4	Reinstall **ConnX eRecruitment Process Applicant Service** from the relevant directory in the extracted upgrade package	5 min	Uninstall new service
3.5	Open `ConnXAutomationProcessConfiguration.exe` as Administrator	2 min	N/A

3.6	Configure Database tab: verify Server Name (`KDR-AZSQL01`), Database Name, Authentication mode, credentials	5 min	Update configuration
3.7	Test database connection from CAP Configuration utility	2 min	Fix credentials/connectivity
3.8	Click **Update** on Service Configuration tab	1 min	N/A
3.9	Start both the ConnX Automation Process and eRecruitment Process services	2 min	Stop services
Phase 3 Total		**~35 min**	

Phase 4: Finalisation & Post-Upgrade Checks			
Step	**Action**	**Duration**	**Rollback**
4.1	On `KDR-AZAPP01` : Start/Restart the ConnX website in IIS Manager	2 min	Stop website
4.1a	**Wait up to 5 minutes** for the site to fully load on first access after upgrade	5 min	N/A
4.2	Verify version number on login screen shows **v7.1.0 2955**	2 min	Investigate upgrade failure
4.3	Check `.../cbww/health` URL — confirm version consistency	2 min	N/A
4.4	Login as full Administrator; verify welcome page and widgets load	5 min	N/A
4.5	Verify licence and version at *Admin* > *General* > *ConnX Licence*	2 min	N/A
4.6	Check System Status page — *Admin* > *System Status*	2 min	N/A
4.7	Verify email settings — *Admin* > *Settings* > *E-mail*; send test email	5 min	N/A
4.8	Verify colour theme preserved — *Admin* > *Settings* > *Colour Theme*	2 min	Re-apply theme
4.9	Test widget creation/upload — *Admin* > *Settings* > *Welcome Widgets*	5 min	N/A

4.10	Test grid export to Excel — *Company Info* > *Employee Directory*	3 min	N/A
4.11	Test graphs — *My Details* > *Leave Dashboard*	2 min	N/A
4.12	Test document viewer — *My Details* > *Employee Documents*	2 min	N/A
4.13	Test payroll integration — *Admin* > *Payroll Databases* (if applicable)	5 min	N/A
4.14	Run Customiser.exe as Administrator to restore customisations (if applicable)	5 min	Contact ConnX support
4.15	Notify users that upgrade is complete and system is available	-	N/A
Phase 4 Total		**~45 min**	

> **Phase 4 Impact:** System coming back online. Users can resume access once verification is complete.

Module-Specific Post-Upgrade Checks (If Applicable)

Module	Check	Verified
Mobile Module	Login to Mobile; confirm Workflow Forms section added to menu	☐
Reports Manager	Run report (Category: Employees, ID 6 — Employee List by Age); verify Crystal Reports working	☐
Dashboards	Open Dashboards; create Gender Distribution dashboard with widgets	☐
Web Service	Test web service connection at *Admin* > *Settings* > *Interfaces - Web Service*	☐
Recruitment (SEEK)	Open *Recruitment* > *Locations*; test SEEK Location lookup	☐
Careers	Run "Get ConnX Careers Applications" from Automated Process Scheduler; check log	☐

4. Maintenance Window Requirements

Phase	Maintenance Window Required	Estimated Duration
Phase 1: Pre-Upgrade Preparation	No	~40 min (business hours OK)

Phase 2: ConnX Application Upgrade	**Yes**	~60-120 min
Phase 3: CAP Update	**Yes**	~25 min
Phase 4: Finalisation & Verification	**Yes**	~45 min

Recommended Maintenance Window:
Duration: 4 hours (includes ~2.5 hours work + 1.5 hours buffer for prerequisites install / server reboot / troubleshooting)
Suggested: Outside business hours — Weekend or Weekday evening

Server Reboot: If .NET Framework 4.8 needs to be installed, a server reboot will be required during the upgrade. Plan accordingly.

5. Risk Assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Database upgrade failure	Low	High	Full database backup taken at Step 2.9; restore from backup
Application file corruption during upgrade	Low	High	Application files backed up at Step 2.8; restore from backup
Server reboot required (.NET 4.8 install)	Medium	Medium	Schedule during maintenance window; allow extra time
SQL Server 2014 incompatibility	Low	High	Verify SQL version is 2016+ before starting upgrade
Database connection failure during upgrade	Low	Medium	Upgrader validates connection at Step 3; have DB credentials ready
Custom web pages lost	Medium	Medium	Run Customiser.exe post-upgrade; contact ConnX support if errors
CAP service fails to connect to database	Low	Medium	Test connection from CAP Configuration utility before starting service
Other applications on shared app pool affected	Medium	Medium	Identify all apps sharing ConnX app pool; notify owners before maintenance
Extended maintenance window	Medium	Low	4-hour window provides 1.5 hours buffer; communicate delay if needed

Email SMTP OAuth changes required (O365)	Medium	Medium	Pre-check email method; coordinate with IT for SMTP OAuth if using O365 Basic Auth

6. Rollback Plan

Full Rollback (if upgrade fails critically)

1. Stop the ConnX website in IIS Manager
2. Restore ConnX application files from backup (taken at Step 2.8)
3. Restore ConnX database from backup (taken at Step 2.9)
4. Restore ConnX Document Datastore database from backup (if applicable)
5. Reinstall the previous version of ConnX Automation Process (CAP)
6. Configure CAP database connection
7. Start the ConnX website and CAP service
8. Verify the original version loads and functions correctly

> **Important:** Both application file backup AND database backup are required for a full rollback. The upgrader modifies both the files and the database schema. One cannot be restored without the other.

Partial Rollback (CAP only)

1. Stop the ConnX Automation Process service
2. Uninstall the new CAP via Control Panel
3. Reinstall the previous CAP version
4. Reconfigure database connection
5. Start the service

7. Pre-Implementation Checklist

Days Before Upgrade

- ☐ Submit change request and obtain approval
- ☐ Inform all **internal and external parties** ahead of time
- ☐ Confirm current ConnX version is v6.5.0.2016 or greater
- ☐ Confirm SQL Server version on `KDR-AZSQL01` is 2016 or above
- ☐ Confirm MicrOpay version if applicable (current: v9.4)
- ☐ Locate download link from original KDR email; if unavailable contact **Jacob.Dack@connx.com.au** or call **1300 266 694**
- ☐ Download ConnX v7.1 Upgrade pack to `KDR-AZAPP01` and extract .zip to a local folder
- ☐ Verify RDP access to `KDR-AZAPP01` and `KDR-AZSQL01`
- ☐ Retrieve `KDR-AZSQL01` local Administrator credentials from [ITGlue]

- ☐ Verify `G:\SQLBackups\ConnX` path exists on `KDR-AZSQL01` with sufficient disk space
- ☐ Verify `C:\TempPath` is available on `KDR-AZAPP01` for application backup
- ☐ Check if external document datastore is in use; verify connection
- ☐ Identify any customised ConnX pages; contact ConnX support if needed
- ☐ Identify other applications sharing the ConnX application pool on `KDR-AZAPP01`
- ☐ Check email sending method; coordinate O365 SMTP OAuth if needed
- ☐ Maintenance window approved and communicated to all parties

Immediately Before Upgrade

- ☐ Verify external document datastore connectivity (last thing before stopping site)
- ☐ Confirm all users have been notified and logged out
- ☐ Verify upgrade package is extracted and ready on `KDR-AZAPP01`
- ☐ Database credentials (SQL auth username/password) available if needed
- ☐ Rollback plan reviewed and ready

8. Post-Implementation Verification

Check	Expected Result	Verified
Login page loads	ConnX login page displays correctly	☐
Version number	Login screen shows **Version 7.1.0 2955**	☐
Health endpoint	`.../cbww/health` returns consistent version	☐
Admin login	Full admin can log in successfully	☐
Welcome page & widgets	Welcome page loads; widgets display correctly	☐
Licence	Version and licensee correct at *Admin > General > ConnX Licence*	☐
System Status	All components operational at *Admin > System Status*	☐
Email	Test email sends successfully	☐
Colour theme	Custom colours preserved	☐
File upload	Can create widget with image upload	☐
Grid export	Employee Directory exports to Excel successfully	☐
Graphs	Leave Dashboard graphs render correctly	☐

Document viewer	Employee Documents can be viewed	☐
Payroll integration	Database connection test passes (if applicable)	☐
Customisations	Customiser.exe ran successfully (if applicable)	☐
CAP service	ConnX Automation Process service running	☐

9. Communication Plan

Pre-Maintenance Notification (48-24 hours before)

Subject: Scheduled ConnX Maintenance — [DATE]

Body:
A scheduled maintenance window has been planned for the ConnX HR system.

Date: [DATE]
Time: [START TIME] - [END TIME]
Impact: ConnX will be unavailable during this window
Reason: Upgrade ConnX from current version to v7.1.0

Please ensure you save all work and log out of ConnX before the maintenance window begins.
All data and settings will be preserved during the upgrade.

Post-Maintenance Notification

Subject: ConnX Maintenance Completed — System Available

Body:
The scheduled ConnX maintenance has been completed successfully. The system has been upgraded to version 7.1.0.

You can now log in to ConnX and resume normal operations.

If you experience any issues, please contact the IT Service Desk.

10. Post-Upgrade Cleanup

- Retain application file backup and database backup for a minimum of **2 weeks**
- After 2 weeks of stable operation, backups can be archived or deleted
- Update any internal documentation referencing ConnX version numbers

11. Vendor Support Contact

Contact	Details
ConnX Support	Ph: 1300 266 694 | Intl: +61 7 3368 2623 | Email: support@connx.com.au
MicrOpay Support	Ph: 1300 729 329 | Email: support.au@theaccessgroup.com

12. Approvals

Role	Name	Date	Signature
Change Requester			
Technical Reviewer			
Change Manager			
CAB Approval			

13. Supporting Documentation

- ConnX V7.1 Upgrade Instructions (42 pages) — Full step-by-step upgrade procedure
- ConnX V7.1 Post Upgrade Checks (10 pages) — Verification checklist for post-upgrade validation
- ConnX V7.1 Release Notes — Details of changes in this release
- ConnX Technical Specifications — Supported OS and SQL Server versions